

01 It's an intangible yet very real part of our daily life.

- ① panacea ② device
③ sample ④ advance
⑤ miscalculation

- 10** Like millions of other teenagers, my 14-year-old daughter Jen is often to be found on the sofa, laptop on her knees, checking facts for the essay she's writing. The TV is on and occasionally she scrolls through Facebook. She texts, makes calls on her mobile and takes her iPod headset on and off. To me — and most other parents — this seems _____. “How can you think with all that noise?” we yell. Homework used to be something to be done in silence, with all distractions firmly removed.
- ① a miserable scene to overcome
 - ② a proper time to leave
 - ③ an appropriate chance to talk to
 - ④ an impossible way to work
 - ⑤ a hopeless situation to ignore

11-15 Choose one that is either ungrammatical or unacceptable.

- 11** It ①wasn't long before I noticed ②that she is incredibly smart. She never ③make the same mistake ④twice and loves ⑤to be praised.
- 12** He sat there, ①lost and lonely in a strange city, ②visualizing the nightmare of ③getting all the paperwork ④organizing again from a distant country while ⑤trying to settle down in a new one.
- 13** Textbooks ①more than a decade ②old will tell you that you die with the same brain you were born ③of, that growing new ④born cells ⑤is impossible.
- 14** The lowest stockpiles in ①decades mean there ②are less grain to buffer the impact of drought, ③floods, and crop failures, ④making prices ⑤more volatile.
- 15** One ①third to ②nearly half of the people in the majority of countries ③surveyed admitted they wanted ④their spouse ⑤losing weight.

16 The following is _____.

When I opened the door, the hallway stretched away in a long cloud. I thought something was wrong with my eyes. On another floor a woman was screaming. We ran outside, and since there was nothing else to do, we watched the car burn. Later that day, a funeral procession for Ali made its way through the Jadriya neighborhood in central Baghdad. The boy's house was only a few feet from where he was killed. His family wrapped the body in white, for martyrdom, and Ali's mother screamed at Bush for doing this to her son.

- | | |
|---------------|-----------|
| ① humorous | ② cynical |
| ③ gloomy | ④ moving |
| ⑤ exaggerated | |

17 The following is a part of _____.

I have been fortunate in having many moral tutors, formal and informal, many of whom had to undergo considerable intellectual trial, and evince notable courage, in order to break with the faith of their tribes. Some of these would still be in some danger if I were to name them, but I must admit my debt to the late Dr. Israel Shahak, who introduced me to Spinoza; to Salman Rushdie, who bravely witnessed for reason and humor and language in a very dark time.

- ① advertisements
- ② a review
- ③ a newspaper article
- ④ a biography
- ⑤ acknowledgments

18 The underlined That infrastructure is for _____.

That infrastructure is starting to emerge in scattered places around the world, especially where governments are encouraging it. In Israel, a country with expensive gasoline and short driving distances, a California-based company called Better Place has constructed more than a thousand charging stations; next year it hopes to begin building a similar network in the San Francisco area. Under the Better Place plan, the company owns and tracks the use of the expensive lithium-ion batteries in its subscribers' cars; they pay a fee to recharge, even when they're recharging at home.

- ① electric vehicles
- ② a big company
- ③ wireless phones
- ④ highway travelers
- ⑤ the Internet users

19 Which one is the most appropriate order following the given sentence?

Xinjiang sits in the middle of Asia, encircled by some of Earth's highest mountains, as though a drawstring had cinched the top of the world like a coin purse.

- (a) "They say it is the highest place in the world," Marco Polo wrote of climbing the Pamir mountains from the Afghanistan side.
- (b) Passes through those snowy mountains funneled ancient traders and travelers along paths that became the renowned Silk Road.
- (c) When he emerged from the pass, he found the Uygur homeland and marveled: "From this country, many merchants go forth about the world."

- | | |
|-------------------|-------------------|
| ① (a) – (b) – (c) | ② (b) – (a) – (c) |
| ③ (c) – (a) – (b) | ④ (a) – (c) – (b) |
| ⑤ (b) – (c) – (a) | |

20 Choose one sentence that is NOT compatible with others.

Last summer, public health experts warned that H1N1, aka swine flu, could afflict up to 50 percent of the US population. ① To prepare, officials readied 50 million doses of initial vaccines for children, pregnant women, and health care workers. ② Though not likely, two other, older techniques — isolation and quarantine — could also eventually be considered. ③ Isolation separates sick people from well ones. ④ Quarantine checks the movements of those who aren't ill and have never been exposed. ⑤ In lieu of a vaccine, these intrusive, oft-debated measures can curb disease spread, lower death rates, and lessen the toll on hospitals.

21-50 Read the following passage and answer the questions.

21-22 For better or for worse, the monastic brotherhood consists of men who finally cannot help but be who they are, fleshed out beneath their robes. Some are independent by nature and opt to live on their own in countryside cells. Some are _____ — and indeed, as one monk says, “monastery life can be absolutely consumed with pettiness.” However, the very best of them do not merely radiate goodwill but seek out where it's most needed. Father Makarios of the Marouda cell near Karyes is such a man, freely bestowing on strangers his spare coat, his spare room, all of the money in his pocket. “With real faith,” the 58-year-old monk with animated green eyes says, “you have freedom. You have love.”

21 Which one is most appropriate for the blank?

- | | |
|----------------|------------|
| ① small-minded | ② agnostic |
| ③ ignorant | ④ devoted |
| ⑤ faithful | |

22 According to the above passage, Father Makarios _____.

- ① has his monastery in countryside
- ② would sacrifice himself for others
- ③ really needs love from others
- ④ is one of the worst monks
- ⑤ doesn't have anything

23-24 A preacher trained his horse to go when he said, "Praise the Lord," and to stop when he said, "Amen." The preacher mounted the horse, said, "Praise the Lord" and went for a ride. When he wanted to stop for lunch, he said, "Amen." He took off again, saying, "Praise the Lord." The horse started going toward the edge of a cliff. The preacher got excited and said, "Whoa!" Then he remembered and said, "Amen," and the horse stopped at the edge of the cliff. The preacher was so relieved and grateful that he looked up to heaven and said, "Praise the Lord!"

23 The above story is _____.

- ① expository
- ② instructive
- ③ sad
- ④ destructive
- ⑤ funny

24 Why did the preacher say the last "Praise the Lord!"?

- ① He wanted to go forward.
- ② He wanted to repeat the procedure.
- ③ He wanted to express his thanks to God.
- ④ He didn't know what to say.
- ⑤ He tried to train the horse again.

25-27 In 1798 Thomas Malthus, an English priest and economist, enunciated his general law of population: that it necessarily grows faster than the food supply, until war, disease, and famine arrive to reduce the number of people. As it turned out, the last plagues great enough to put a dent in global population had already happened when Malthus wrote. World population hasn't fallen, historians think, since the Black Death of the 14th century.

In the two centuries after Malthus declared that population couldn't continue to soar, that's exactly what it did. The process started in what we now call the developed countries, which were then still developing. The spread of New World crops like corn and the potato, along with the discovery of chemical fertilizers, helped banish starvation in Europe. Growing cities remained cesspools of disease at first, but from the mid-19th century on, sewers began to channel human waste away from drinking water, which was then filtered and chlorinated; that dramatically reduced the spread of cholera and typhus.

Moreover in 1798, the same year that Malthus published his dyspeptic tract, his compatriot Edward Jenner described a vaccine for small-pox — the first and most important in a series of vaccines and antibiotics that, along with better nutrition and sanitation, would double life expectancy in the industrializing countries, from 35 years to 77 today.

25 What does the underlined that's exactly what it did mean?

- ① the number of people decreased a lot
- ② too many people were killed in the World War
- ③ people began to live longer than before
- ④ the world population continued to grow fast
- ⑤ everything went as he predicted

26 Malthus' general law of population turned out to be false because he _____.

- ① couldn't think of the modern development
- ② didn't know the exact population
- ③ published his tract too late
- ④ got the idea from the Bible
- ⑤ didn't count the world wars

27 Which one did NOT contribute to the growth of population?

- ① vaccines
- ② chemical fertilizers
- ③ growing cities
- ④ the sewers
- ⑤ crops in the USA

28-29 Not to be confused with the common cold, which is generally milder, the flu is a contagious viral infection of the respiratory tract, and can affect anyone from toddlers to expectant mothers and seniors. (a) This same group, pending other existing health conditions, are also the most susceptible to flu-related complications that may lead to death. (b) Traditionally, fighting the flu has largely been within the domain of Western medicine. (c) The ubiquitous flu vaccination remains the frontline between the flu bug and body resistance; each shot essentially contains a small dose of flu viruses that the body learns to develop antibodies against. (d) After symptoms show themselves, people turn to their GPs or the pharmacy for help. (e) GPs generally prescribe a range of symptoms-easing drugs, which may include paracetamol (for fever and aches), codeine (for coughs), danzen (to soothe throat inflammation) and antihistamines (to unblock stuffy noses or stop the sniffles). Meanwhile, antiviral drugs like Tamiflu and Relenza help shorten the time you have flu symptoms by stopping the spread of the virus in your body.

28 When the above passage is divided into three paragraphs, which would be the best boundaries?

- ① (a) and (c) ② (a) and (d)
③ (b) and (d) ④ (b) and (e)
⑤ (c) and (e)

29 Which one is NOT true of the above passage?

- ① Flu is different from cold.
- ② Catching flu can be critical to some patients.
- ③ Flu is transmitted by a sort of virus.
- ④ Flu vaccine eliminates the flu viruses.
- ⑤ There's no cure for flu.

33-35 It took humans thousands of years to explore our own planet and centuries to comprehend our neighboring planets, but nowadays new worlds are being discovered every week. To date, astronomers have identified more than 370 “exoplanets,” worlds orbiting stars other than the sun. Many are so strange as to confirm the biologist J.B. Haldane’s famous remark that “the universe is not only queerer than we suppose, but queerer than we can suppose.” There’s an Icarus-like “hot Saturn” 260 light-years from Earth, whirling around its parent star so rapidly that a year there lasts less than three days. Circling another star 150 light-years out is a scorched “hot Jupiter,” whose upper atmosphere is being blasted off to form a gigantic, comet-like tail. Three benighted planets have been found orbiting a pulsar — the remains of a once mighty star shrunk into a spinning atomic nucleus the size of a city — while untold numbers of worlds have evidently fallen into their suns or been flung out of their systems to become “floaters” that wander in eternal darkness.

Amid such exotica, scientists are eager for a hint of the familiar: planets resembling Earth, orbiting their stars at just the right distance — neither too hot nor too cold — to support life as we know it. No planets quite like our own have yet been found, presumably because they’re _____. To see a planet as small and dim as ours amid the glare of its star is like trying to see a firefly in a fireworks display; to detect its gravitational influence on the star is like listening for a cricket in a tornado. Yet by pushing technology to the limits, astronomers are rapidly approaching the day when they can find another Earth and interrogate it for signs of life.

33 According to the context, Earth’s parent star would be _____.

- | | |
|------------|------------|
| ① the sun | ② Saturn |
| ③ the moon | ④ a planet |
| ⑤ comet | |

34 The best expression for the blank would be _____.

- | | |
|-----------------|-------------------|
| ① too large | ② floating around |
| ③ inconspicuous | ④ transparent |
| ⑤ transient | |

35 The best title of the passage would be _____.

- ① Our Own Planet: Earth
- ② Icarus-like "hot Saturn"
- ③ Queer Universe
- ④ The Floaters
- ⑤ Seeking New Earths

36-37 The helicopter drops over a narrow embankment, showering the skinny men and boys perched on it with flotsam and brown floodwater. They rush forwards, waving and yelling soundlessly against the roar of rotary blades. Six weeks after torrential rains caused the Indus river to break its banks, inundating their mud-walled villages in Rajanpur, a district of southern Punjab, their anguish is not feigned. They are hungry, destitute and still marooned by a floodwater sea.

Through the chopper's open door, Shahbaz Sharif, chief minister of Punjab, pitches a sack of food, then looks down and heaves out another. The younger brother of Pakistan's opposition leader and twice prime minister, Nawaz Sharif, whose Pakistan Muslim League rules Punjab, Mr. Sharif has spent almost every day since the floods hit marshalling dykes and dispensing relief. His rivals accuse him of taking advantage from the deluge, which at its height submerged a fifth of Pakistan's area and affected over 20 million people. But the country would be in less calamitous shape if more officials worked as hard as he.

36 The helicopter is _____.

- ① distributing the food to flood victims
- ② videotaping the flood area
- ③ flying to pick up Mr. Sharif
- ④ checking the size of the disaster
- ⑤ trying to lift up the men

37 The author believes Mr. Sharif _____.

- ① is exploiting the situation
- ② doesn't like what he is doing
- ③ will win the next election
- ④ is doing a good job
- ⑤ is spoiling the people

The merchants of fake fun have met some resistance. When Wal-Mart tried to impose alien rules on its German staff — such as compulsory smiling and a ban on affairs with co-workers — it touched off a guerrilla war that ended only when the supermarket chain announced it was pulling out of Germany in 2006. But such victories are rare. For most wage slaves forced to pretend they are having fun at work, the only relief is to poke fun at their tormentors. Popular culture provides some inspiration. “You don’t have to be mad to work here. In fact, we ask you to complete a medical questionnaire to ensure that you are not,” deadpans David Brent, the risible boss in “The Office”, a satirical television series. Homer Simpson’s employer, a nuclear-power plant, has regular “funny hat days” but lax safety standards. “Mad Men” reminds people of a world they have lost — a world where bosses did not think that “fun” was a management tool and where employees could happily quaff at Scotch at noon. Cheers to that.

- 39** The above passage suggests that _____.

40 According to the passage, most employees have fun when _____.

- ① they have their own work
- ② they can enjoy their work
- ③ they get pay raise
- ④ they can go back home early
- ⑤ they ridicule their bosses

41-42 For at least 10,000 years, since the ice last retreated and forests took back the earth, people have destroyed them. In medieval Europe an exploding population and hard-working monks put paid to perhaps half its temperate oak and beech woods — mostly, as is usually the case, to clear space for crops. Some 100 million hectares of America's forests went in the 19th century, in an arboreal slaughter similarly reinforced by a belief in the godliness of thus "improving" the land. That spirit survives. It is no coincidence that George Bush junior, one of America's more god-fearing presidents, relaxed by clearing brush.

41 In medieval Europe, people cut trees to _____.

- ① cultivate farmland
- ② build a house
- ③ make necessary things
- ④ pay a fine
- ⑤ heat the house

42 What does the underlined "That spirit" mean?

- ① praising God for His glory
- ② looking for New World like America
- ③ praying to God for His kingdom
- ④ sacrificing forests for development
- ⑤ campaigning for nature conservation

The “education is good” mantra does not work everywhere. In some countries many students have to be content with the intellectual rewards of study. In Spain, for example, 44% of college- and university-educated youngsters are working in jobs for which they are overqualified. In lucky Luxembourg hardly any graduates end up in menial jobs.

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46-47 A young parish minister about to deliver his first sermon asked a retired cleric for advice on how to capture the congregation's attention. "Start with an opening line that's certain to grab them," the older man said. "For example: 'Some of the best years of my life were spent in the arms of a woman who was not my wife.'" He smiled at the younger man's shocked expression before adding, "She was my mother."

The next Sunday the young clergyman nervously clutched the pulpit rail in front of the congregation. Finally he said, "Some of the best years of my life were spent in the arms of a woman."

He was pleased at the instant reaction — then became panic-stricken. "But for the life of me, I can't remember who she was!"

46 The above story is _____.

- ① exciting
- ② serious
- ③ enlightening
- ④ humorous
- ⑤ moving

47 The best title of the story would be _____.

- ① Sinful
- ② Rejecting Help
- ③ Forgetful
- ④ Best Sermon
- ⑤ Getting Old

Let us see how dictionaries are made and how the editors arrive at definitions. What follows applies, incidentally, only to those dictionary offices where first-hand, original research goes on — not those in which editors simply copy existing dictionaries. The task of writing a dictionary begins with reading vast amounts of the literature of the period or subject that the dictionary is to cover. As the editors read, they copy on cards every interesting or rare word, every unusual or peculiar occurrence of a common word, a large number of common words in their ordinary uses, and also the sentences in which each of these words appears.

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